Read Words in Context

Vocabulary Words

admiral
butte
cashmere
eureka
gourmet
kangaroo
menu
mesa
moustache
pajamas
parka
patio
safari
sherbet
tortilla

Word Learning Tip!

Some words in our language look or sound different because they were first used in another language or another country. We borrowed these words and use them as part of the English language. Knowing a word's history can help you understand its meaning.

Vocabulary Building Strategy

Knowing something about the language from which an unknown word comes can be a clue to its meaning. The vocabulary words come from Spanish, French, Hindi, Arabic, Greek, and Russian. As they came into English, sometimes their spelling and pronunciation changed. When you read a word from another language, connect what you know about its history and context clues to determine its meaning.

READ!

The Big Sale



The **patio** of the old house is piled with stuff for the garage sale. "Look at all the things on the deck." Mom says. Tamika and Danny groan as they carry toys, clothing, and other old stuff to the tables.

People start arriving. A little girl grabs a stuffed **kangaroo** toy. "It's such a cute animal," she says. "I can pretend to take it on a **safari** to Africa." "Don't you know anything?" says her brother. "A kangaroo is from Australia." A man grabs a pair of green **pajamas** and a woolly **cashmere** sweater. "Did you know that cashmere got its name from the hair of goats from the region of Kashmir?" Tamika says. "**Eureka**!" another man yells. "Fancy **gourmet** pots and pans! Just what I need because I'm an expert cook!"

The **admiral** comes over from next door to see what all the fuss is about. "You know I command a fleet of ships," he says. "Do you have any model boats for my collection?" A man with a bushy white **moustache** and beard is looking for a comb.

Meanwhile, Angela sells her old **parka**. "I'm visiting from Arizona," the buyer says. "I need this coat for the cold winters out on the **mesa**," he explains. "I like to climb to the top of the **butte** and watch the sun set."

At the end of the sale, everyone is too tired to cook. "Where is the take-out **menu**?" they groan. Reading through the list of foods, Mike says, "I'll have a **tortilla**."

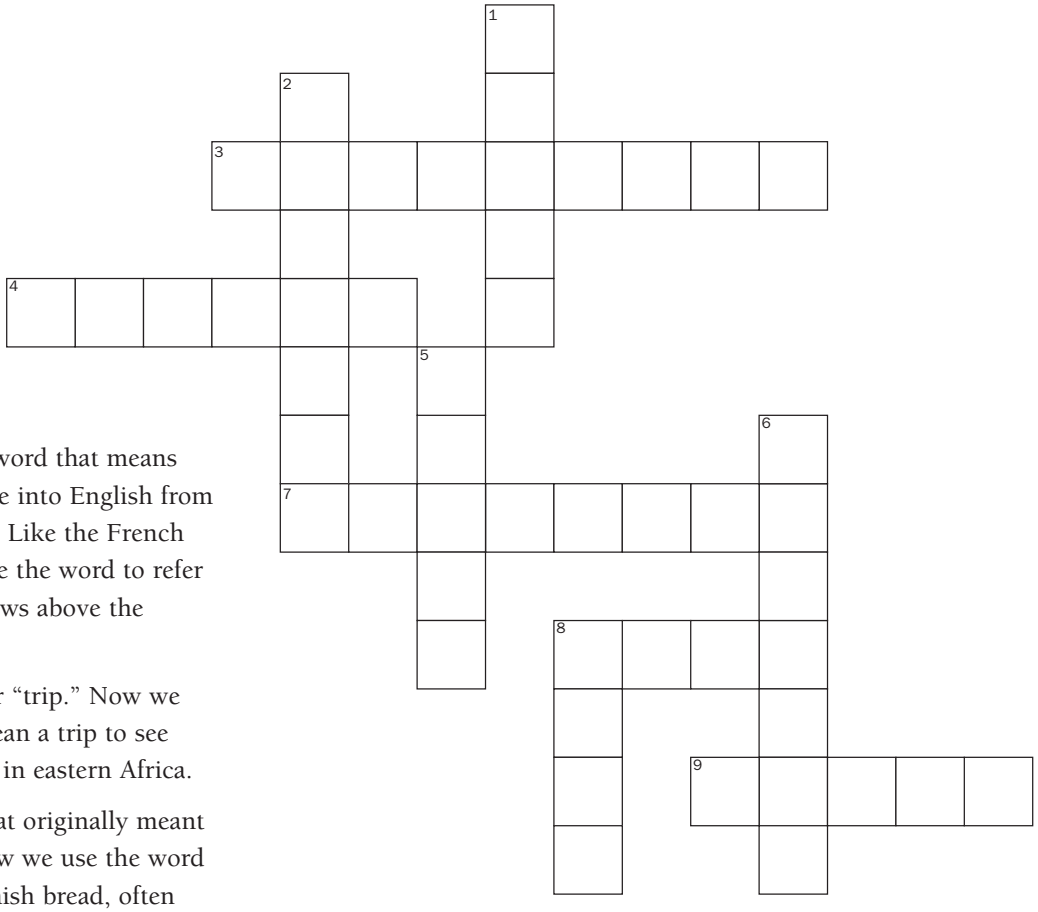
"I know that word," Danny says, "It means 'little cake'! But I think the tortilla on the menu is a bread stuffed with beef and cheese. And I want some **sherbet** for dessert. It's a frozen fruit treat."
"My kids are such gourmets!" Mom says with a laugh.

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Connect Words and Meanings

admiral	eureka	menu	pajamas	safari
butte	gourmet	mesa	parka	sherbet
cashmere	kangaroo	moustache	patio	tortilla

Directions Read each clue below. Write the correct vocabulary word in the crossword puzzle. You may use your dictionary or the glossary to help you.



Across

3. An ancient Greek word that means "upper lip." It came into English from French and Italian. Like the French and Italians, we use the word to refer to the hair that grows above the upper lip.

4. An Arabic word for "trip." Now we use the word to mean a trip to see animals, especially in eastern Africa.

7. A Spanish word that originally meant "a small cake." Now we use the word to mean a flat Spanish bread, often served with a filling.

8. A word borrowed from Spanish that originally came from the Latin word for table. It means "a small, high plateau or tableland with steep sides."

9. A Spanish word that originally meant "an open area or courtyard." We use the word to name a paved area next to the house used for dining or relaxing.

Down

1. A French word that originally meant "mound." It is a small mesa.

2. A French word for a person who knows and appreciates fine foods. We also use the word to describe a food store or restaurant that provides fine food.

5. A Russian word that means "a skin shirt" or "a fur coat." We use the word to name any heavy hooded jacket.

6. A Hindi word that means "loose-fitting trousers." Now we use the word to mean "clothes worn for sleeping."

8. A French word that means "small, detailed" and names a detailed list of food in a restaurant.

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Connect More Words and Meanings

admiral	eureka	menu	pajamas	safari
butte	gourmet	mesa	parka	sherbet
cashmere	kangaroo	moustache	patio	tortilla

Directions Write the correct vocabulary word next to the definition. Then read its history. Finally, read the sentence that follows the history and write the vocabulary word in the blank.

1. **Definition:** officer in the Navy _____

   History: The word comes from an Arabic word that means "commander of the sea."

2. **Sentence:** The _____ ordered the fleet of ships to the North Sea.

3. **Definition:** an exclamation meaning "I have found it!" _____

   History: According to legend, the Greek scientist Archimedes yelled this when he figured out the answer to a problem.

4. **Sentence:** "_____! I found the gold!"

5. **Definition:** frozen fruit dessert _____

   History: The word comes from an Arabic word that means "fruit drink."

6. **Sentence:** Because it was such a hot day, Ryan ordered a cool orange _____.

7. **Definition:** soft wool _____

   History: This word comes from Kashmir, India, the place where this wool comes from.

8. **Sentence:** Desai received a _____ sweater as a gift from his uncle.

9. **Definition:** an Australian animal with short legs in front and long powerful legs in back _____

   History: The word comes from the Australian word for this strange-looking animal.

10. **Sentence:** The female _____ has a pouch where its babies rest.

Understand More Words From Spanish *Mesa* and *tortilla* trace their roots to Spanish. Write the histories and meanings of the following words, which also entered English from Spanish: *fiesta, siesta, bonanza, pronto,* and *tango*. Use your dictionary or the Internet to help you.

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Use Words in Context

admiral	eureka	menu	pajamas	safari
butte	gourmet	mesa	parka	sherbet
cashmere	kangaroo	moustache	patio	tortilla

Directions Choose the correct vocabulary word to fill in each missing word in this ad. Write it on the line.

Big Garage Sale on Saturday

We are selling soft **1.**_____ (*gourmet, sherbet, cashmere*) sweaters. We also have outdoor clothing such as a brand new **2.**_____ (*pajamas, parka, tortilla*). There are toy animals, like a stuffed **3.**_____ (*safari, patio, kangaroo*), too. We are selling a(n) **4.**_____ (*admiral, moustache, mesa*) trimmer. Ladies, this will make a great gift for your husband if he has bristly hairs growing above his upper lip. **5.**"_____ (*Eureka, Butte, Menu*)!" you will yell when you find just what you need at our garage sale.

We're also selling fancy **6.**_____ (*menu, safari, gourmet*) snacks. You can get a hot **7.**_____ (*tortilla, pajamas, cashmere*) filled with beans or a cool bowl of **8.**_____ (*parka, admiral, sherbet*) to eat. Just read the **9.**_____ (*menu, tortilla, kangaroo*) we will have posted on a big blackboard to see what food we have.

The sale will be held on our **10.**_____ (*safari, parka, patio*) at 555 Main Street, starting at 9:00 A.M. See you there!



Dress for (Word) Success! *Cashmere* and *parka* are words about clothing. Find the histories and meanings for these five words about clothing: *leotard, bikini, bloomers, cardigan, knickers*. Then choose any five of these seven clothing words and use them in a clothing ad.

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Put Words Into Action

admiral	eureka	menu	pajamas	safari
butte	gourmet	mesa	parka	sherbet
cashmere	kangaroo	moustache	patio	tortilla

Directions Sort the words according to the language they come from. Then write the meaning of each word.

Words From Spanish — **Meaning**

1. _____ _____
2. _____ _____
3. _____ _____

Words From Greek

4. _____ _____
5. _____ _____

Word From Australia

6. _____ _____

Words From Arabic

7. _____ _____
8. _____ _____
9. _____ _____

Words From French

10. _____ _____
11. _____ _____
12. _____ _____

Word From Russia

13. _____ _____

Words From India

14. _____ _____
15. _____ _____



Name That Word's History Select one of the vocabulary words. Write three clues to your word's history, pronunciation, and meaning—but don't name the word! Challenge classmates to guess the word that you selected and its origin.

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Review and Extend

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cashmere	kangaroo	moustache	patio	tortilla

Bonus Words Every word in this lesson has an interesting history because it entered English from another language. Here are five more words that English has gained from other languages:

Word	History	Meaning
algebra	Arabic word for "joining parts"	a type of mathematics in which symbols and letters are used for unknown numbers
resumé	French word for "summing up"	list of one's work history and education
faux pas	French word for "false step"	a mistake
finale	Italian word for "end"	last part of a musical piece or show
typhoon	Chinese word for "great wind"	a violent tropical storm

Directions Read each item below. Then write an answer to the question. Use the boldface words in your answer.

1. Why might a **gourmet** chef send his **resumé** to a new restaurant?

_____

2. Why would it be a **faux pas** to wear **pajamas** to a fancy party?

_____

3. When might you shout "**Eureka**!" while doing an **algebra** problem?

_____

4. Why would you turn the lights out on the **patio** after the **finale** of an outdoor concert?

_____

5. What might an **admiral** order the fleet to do if he hears a **typhoon** is developing?

_____

Play a Word Game Write each vocabulary and bonus word on the front of an index card and its history and meaning on the back. Then play a game with three classmates. The first player says the word, the second gives the history, and the third gives the meaning.

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Check Your Mastery

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Directions Circle the letter of the correct answer to each question below.

1. Where is an **admiral** most likely to be found?
A. riding a kangaroo
B. on a safari
C. piloting a ship on the ocean
D. on the patio

2. When would you most likely wear a **parka**?
A. in the summer **B.** in the cold **C.** with your pajamas **D.** while swimming

3. Which of the following would most likely appear on a **menu**?
A. cashmere **B.** a safari **C.** a moustache **D.** a tortilla

4. What would make a person shout "**Eureka!**"?
A. a surprising discovery
B. a boring movie
C. a bowl of sherbet
D. a restful nap

5. What would a **gourmet** likely prefer?
A. fancy food **B.** pajamas **C.** a new sweater **D.** a football game

6. A **mesa** is shaped very much like what?
A. a cone **B.** a bowl **C.** a table **D.** a car

7. Which of the following would most likely be made of **cashmere**?
A. a car **B.** a floor **C.** breakfast **D.** a sweater

8. Where does a **kangaroo** live?
A. Australia **B.** Eureka **C.** under the ocean **D.** the Arctic

9. Which of the following describes a **butte**?
A. rainy **B.** steep sides **C.** very deep **D.** looks like a triangle

10. What would you go on a **safari** to see?
A. pajamas **B.** clouds **C.** rare books **D.** wild animals

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